



Oyakhi Ibhagui

to me, CHONG ▾

Nov 23, 2025, 5:31 PM (2 days ago)



Hello James - and Chong

Seeing from the graph on page 25, they're direct quotes, i.e. X/USD; so how many USD can 1X buy. I think we misguided the referee by not stating this in the data description; I've tried to do that.

I'm suggesting we try to avoid a hard work as much as possible and respond to their request without expanding the current paper too much; we should focus on correctness and accuracy. There is no time to spend 2 months expanding the theory when the deadline to submit the revision is just 33 days from now.

Please take a look at what has been done so far in the paper in response to the referee's report. Critically examine it and let me know if you think it addresses the referee's points, especially those points you also reiterated. Check them against what has been done.

Thanks

Regards

Oyakhi

From: James Evans <jamwevan@umich.edu>

Sent: Sunday, November 23, 2025 1:03 PM

To: CHONG HAN <chongh3814@g.ucla.edu>; Oyakhi Ibhagui <oibhagu1@jhu.edu>

Subject: Re: Fw: Decision on submission to Journal of International Financial Markets, Institutions & Money





James Evans <jamwevan@umich.edu>

to Oyakhi, CHONG ▾

Nov 24, 2025, 7:52 PM (5 hours ago)



Hello Oyakhi,

I've concluded my review of your revisions, and here are my thoughts:

- **Currency selection.** You did a good job justifying the currency set, which addresses the reviewer's concern: *"The focus on 'major' pairs is reasonable, but the selection excludes widely traded pairs such as USD/CAD and NZD/USD... The rationale for exclusion should be stated explicitly."*
- **Research gap.** The research gap is now clearly stated, directly addressing: *"The research gap is not clearly stated... Contributions should clearly state how this paper differs and contributes to the existing literature."*
- **Research hypotheses.** We now have a clear and well-motivated hypothesis section, which responds to: *"There should be a separate discussion to derive clear research hypotheses... emphasizing the theoretical channels and explaining why filling the gap advances our knowledge."*
- **Model rationale.** You provided a solid justification for our model and highlighted the drawbacks of alternative approaches such as TVP-VAR and Q-VAR, addressing: *"The authors should explain the rationale behind constructing the model and the comparative advantage over other approaches."*
- **Data frequency.** The rationale for using daily data is now clearly presented, addressing the request for justification of data frequency and sample selection.
- **Acronyms.** BIS is now defined on page 7, resolving the comment that acronyms should be defined at first use.
- **Theoretical background.** The new theoretical background section addresses: *"Theoretical background of the linkages under study should be presented, including channels related to currencies, investment, market efficiency, and arbitrage."*
- **Research motivation.** The revised introduction now articulates the motivation and novelty of the study, addressing: *"Research motivation is absent-minded... What new ingredients do the authors contribute, and why are they important?"*
- **Quotation conventions.** The issue regarding mixing direct and indirect USD quotes (e.g., EUR/USD vs. USD/JPY) is now explicitly addressed.

Remaining Items to Address

- **In-text citations need correction.** We should ensure the formatting matches the journal's guidelines. Could you share their citation guide so I can verify the formatting?
- **Introduction structure.** The final paragraph of the introduction should briefly outline the structure of the rest of the paper.
- **Tables.** The tables need to be presented in a more professional manner. They should include clear notes explaining their contents, including the sample period.
- **Conclusion.** The conclusion should include avenues for future research.

Warm Regards,

James Evans

[Github](#) | (203) 512-9663 | [LinkedIn](#)

University of Michigan | Class of 2027

CS | Data Science | Mathematics | Statistics

